

of the black-bean-and-sausage stew called *feijoada*. Food sets the rhythm of the day in the land of the samba – and around the world.

This book explores more than 125 destinations around the globe, with itineraries that pinpoint must-see attractions, from the dimly lit tango halls of Buenos Aires to the mirrored walls of the Jain Temple on Mumbai's Malabar Hill. Because taste and place are often inseparable, the book also identifies signature dishes and dining experiences for each destination. Riding the Star Ferry across Victoria Harbour and haggling over carvings in the Jade Market are don't-miss experiences for every traveler to Hong Kong. So is eating dim sum in a crowded restaurant – summoning the rolling carts of steamed delights until finally tasting the perfect *har gau* (shrimp dumpling).

The hundreds of restaurant recommendations have been hand-picked by the authors for unsurpassed versions of a destination's signature dish. They also identify other places to find the dishes in the region (where you can sometimes try interesting regional variations) and even around the world. The dining spots range from cozy one-room *bouchons* in Lyon to a theatrical 900-seat duck restaurant in Beijing, from brightly lit 24-hour taco stands in Mexico City to lobster shacks on floating docks along the craggy Maine coast. They share a single characteristic: authenticity.

Encountering a familiar food in its birthplace is one pleasure of any journey. From a hillside vista, a traveler can drink in the sweep of Naples: its red-tile rooftops cascading down to the crescent harbor, the ominous volcanic peak of Vesuvius on the horizon, the garden isles of Capri and Ischia bobbing in the bay. Down in the pulsing heart of the city, a tangle of Vespas stands outside every pizzeria as their riders wait for bubbling pies to emerge from wood-fired beehive ovens.

Travel can also unveil surprising culinary experiences and new flavors. Mozambique's capital Maputo, for example, fuses African heart and Mediterranean style. At every turn it is as spicy and exotic as the piquant chili-based piri-piri sauce ladled over barbecued chicken and shrimp at the city's finest restaurants and casual roadside stands. Whatever your destination, this book offers the promise of a good meal and convivial surroundings at the end of the day.

Nearly two centuries ago, French epicure Jean Anthelme Brillat-Savarin wrote, "Tell me what you eat, and I will tell you who you are." The food experiences presented in this book will certainly leave you fulfilled, both in body and in spirit.

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Below right Open-air food stand vendor serving spicy tea and snacks in Jemaa el-Fna, Marrakech, Morocco

